willingness to give up the man as also the Chronometers, clothes &c taken from the wreck, and left the question of reward to be decided by H.B.M.'s Consul; trusting his delay in giving him up by the plea that he did not like to trust him to the Chinese. The steward was sent in the following day and I, at once, started with the 9 men for Takao. × × × ×.

Chen pu Luen tribe is, as far as I can learn, not under the rule of Tau Ketok. I was informed at Liukiu that Tau Ketok had, on several occasions, inquired after General LeGendre and expressed a great desire to see him again in order that they might renew the treaty.

(Signed) J. Pelham Warren.

No 12. Peking, October 23rd, 1874.

Your Excellency:

I have been informed that the conference of the 18th instant closed almost point for point as I had prognosticated I would in my despatch to Your Excellency of the day previous. But a note which came from the Yamên during the afternoon of the 19th banished all the hopes of a prompt and satisfactory conclusion of our negotiations which this conference had led many to entertain. From a perusal of the Yamên's note, no doubt could be left that the great difficulty would be to induce the Chinese to satisfy the money demands of Japan. Mr. Hart made no mystery of this wish nor, he also said, whether truly or not I do not know, that it was only lately that, yielding to his pressing solicitations, they had agreed to include money considerations among those which might form the basis of a settlement, but that whatever money might be paid should not be considered as an indemnity for the costs of the expedition our right to send which they

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persisted in charging, but as a compensation for certain improvements made by us near Liang-Kiao, such as Houses built and roads made, or as a gratuity, freely offered by the Chinese Emperor, to be apportioned between the soldiers who had accompanied the mission and the families of those who had been killed by the Koukans. In this way, the claim for damages made by Japan for fitting out the mission, maintaining the troops that accompanied it, and withdrawing them from Formosa, would be necessarily excluded.

The next day, Mr. Okubo, to whom I had already communicated the substance of my conversation with Mr. Hart, again met the Chinese ministers. At this interview, although they expressed a willingness, in a general way, to compensate Japan in the manner indicated by Mr. Hart, they carefully avoided naming any figure. "We know what you have spent," they cunningly said, "and it is useless to speak of it here". They also gave Mr. Okubo to understand that they were not prepared to embody in a formal treaty the terms of the settlement, should one be arrived at; that a verbal promise was all that they could offer in guarantee of their good faith; and that even this promise could not be given effect to until after the withdrawal of the Japanese troops from Formosa! Of course, Mr. Okubo told them that, however willing

he was to save China from being humiliated, his concessions could not reach so low a point as they desired. Moreover, probably more with a view to fully ascertain their true intentions than with any hope of learning anything satisfactory from them, he granted their request that Mr. Tei should go to the Yamên on the next day to discuss with the under-officers, preparatory to the final interview which he agreed to have with them on the 23rd.

When Mr. Tei spoke to the Yamên of $500,000 as being the amount which would satisfy the High Commissioner, they appeared much surprised, and said that $500,000 had seemed to them to be the utmost that China could agree to pay; but that Prince Kung should be consulted. Mr. Okubo was much incensed; but considering that he was sent here not as a Commissioner of war, but as one of peace, and that, as such, he must patiently follow to the end every link of the chain that yet held China and Japan together in the bonds of peace before he could look upon his mission as ended, he determined to wait until after the next day's interview before deciding what his next step should be.

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During the afternoon the minister for Math. Pereira called on me, and from what he said, I was confirmed in the opinion that the Tsung-li Yamên, having no definite plans, although engaged in peaceful negociations with Mr. Okubo, were not altogether unconscious of the necessity of preparing for war. It appears that, in a recent interview with the minister, they had applied to him for two iron-clads; and this, together with his reply to them and a few rumors which had reached me through what had hitherto proved reliable Chinese sources, I embodied in my telegram No 11, copy of which I beg to enclose. (See Enclosure No 1.)

To-day, the final interview between Mr. Okubo and the Tsung-li Yamên has taken place; and although it apparently ended in a close of the negociations, yet it is my opinion that new conferences will be held at no distant day, at the instances of Mr. Wade. However this may be, and even if a rupture should follow Mr. Okubo's return to Japan, I do not think that it could be the means of lessening the credit which the High Commissioner has gained during his stay here. His position from the very first has been a most difficult one. When he left Tokei,

the invasion of Formosa was still considered by the generality of the public, who were unacquainted with the facts of the case, as giving to China, who was then quite unprepared for war, a casus belli against Japan, who, comparatively speaking, was ready. But it applied apparently to Japan, this seeming her in a position almost desperate; for she could only parry the blow that threatened her by a home-thrust at her antagonist before the latter could be ready to fall upon her with irresistible force. Without going into the details of the negociations in Pekin, and without taking for granted the fact, which is far from being established in my mind, that they are ended without any hope of renewal, I feel justified in saying that they have resulted in extricating Japan from her embarrassing position, and obtaining for her liberty of action with due regard to her obligations under international law as recognized by civilized nations. This was the more difficult to accomplish that the British ministers, both in China and Japan, chiefly with the view of protecting the traffic of England, (a) had shown a disposition to maintain peace at all hazards, and that, to this

(a). See Mr. Edmund's valuable account of his conversation with Mr. Wade, enclosed with my despatch No 10.

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effect, one of them, Mr. Wade, actually spoke of British intervention in case of war; and, having called upon Mr. Okubo, asked how explanations, under the pretext that he had heard but one side of the questions, and that he was anxious to give the weight of his influence to the party who was in the right. With admirable ability, Mr. Okubo evaded this danger by clearly demonstrating to the Ministers that, so long as his negociations with the Tsung-li Yamen involved only points of honor between China and Japan, he could confer with no one about them, excepting parties directly interested; but he said that he would give them full details of his proceedings as soon as these points were settled. At last, when the time came when he could speak, it was found that the British Ministers was already convinced by Mr. Okubo that the conditions for the evacuation of Formosa by Japan were just; and from that time it became evident that, if there should be any interference at all on his part, it must be all in favor of Japan; and this, not at any request of Japan, but solely to protect British interests, compromised by the obstinacy and injustice of China. So if China persists in her refusal to comply with these conditions, and, by her preparations for war, threatens to force upon Japan her unjust claims, Japan, in self defence, may resist them; and by so doing, she cannot fail to enlist on her side the sympathies of the world.

Another good result of Mr. Okubo's negociations is that China is probably not more prepared for war now than when we first came to Peking. During the nine months Mr. Okubo has awaited with ceaseless anxiety whereby a contest between the two countries might have been precipitated as a determination on the part of Japan to evade a war at all hazards, China has suddenly slackened her war preparations at the very time she should have executed them with the utmost vigor, if she wished to be ready for any emergency. Among other things, she has refused to give the Foochow Viceroy the necessary powers to conclude a loan of $6,000,000 (See despatch, No 10.); and she has stopped the organization of her troops on a large scale. If Japan is ready, when Mr. Okubo returns to Yokei, she may immediately declare war with less apprehensions of getting involved in the contest than she had when the present mission left for China.

Mr. Okubo has announced that he will leave Peking on the 26th inst. I have made my arrangements to leave, and will leave, on the 25th, unless the Chinese, moved at last by Mr. Okubo's determination, come to him and unconditionally yield to his demands.

I have the honor to be,
Your Excellency's
Most obedient humble Servant,
Chas. W. Le Gendre

His Excellency
Okuma Shigenobu
Minister of Colonization;
&c. &c.

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Memo. No. 41.

The Baron de Halleben called at my place yesterday and said to me that the Chinese had applied to him to know whether the Emperor of Germany would consent to sell two of his iron-clads to China; to which the Minister had replied that, far from having any such vessels for sale, His Majesty had just ordered ten more to be built.

During the afternoon I was told by one who had it from the priest of the temple where I live, that the Chinese had decided not to pay an indemnity to Japan, as they had been informed that not less than $3,500,000 or $4,000,000 would satisfy her. Evidently the priest's informant received his information before the Tsung li Yamên had seen Mr. Tei, and the figures had been given them by Mr. Hart, who, I suppose, had designedly raised the figure which I gave him.

I was also told that, at the next conference, that is, tomorrow, they would again endeavor to obtain the withdrawal of the Japanese troops from Formosa, upon the promise that, when this had been done, they would amicably settle their present difficulties with Japan; that, however, with a view to avoid a war, they are now considering whether it would not be advisable, in case of their being unable to obtain the withdrawal of these troops, to frankly acknowledge that, having several times failed in their efforts to conquer Aboriginal Formosa, they had found it impossible to occupy it, and consequently Japan had a right to do so; and that, confident that Japan will be a good neighbor to them, they will no longer object to her occupation of it.

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It seems to me that, should China come forward with this unexpected proposition, Japan might accept it as a basis of settlement, provided that China will fully acknowledge, by a treaty of amity, settlement and limits, the right of Japan to Aboriginal Formosa, and at once disband her troops and disarm. It is now evident that all her preparations for war have been directed solely against Japan, and that, so long as they are going on, they constitute a danger to that country which will become a just and sufficient Casus belli, as is explained in my Memo. No. 36.

I understand that the French minister is going to the Tsung li Yamên today, not to speak to them concerning Japanese affairs, but to request an audience to take leave of the Emperor.

Peking, October 22nd, 1874.

Respectfully submitted.
(signed) Chas. de Kerdrel.

His Excellency
Okubo Toshimichi,
H.I.J.M's High Commissioner,
etc. etc. etc.

Tientsin le 24 Octobre 1874.

Cher Monsieur

Je devais la première occasion pour vous répondre à votre aimable lettre. Cela vous étonne, mais néanmoins c'est juste, car j'ai reçu votre lettre, datée du 21 Septembre, il n'y a que deux jours. Où elle se trouvait pendant ces quarante jours, c'est un problème que je ne puis expliquer, qu'elle ne m'est pas venue probablement par la route de Suez. Mais ce n'est pas ma faute assurément. Voyez la réponse tel qu'elle est.

Je regrette beaucoup cette circonstance malheureuse, comme elle me prive peut-être de recevoir quelques lettres de vous sur la position générale des affaires

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Tungchow 10 P.M.
26th Oct.

Dear Mr Yukuwara

General Le Gendre wishes to know if anything has been heard from the Tsungli Yamen since we left. We send this by special courier, who is to return tomorrow morning by 11 A.M. and we shall wait his return here. Boats are all ready for Mr Okubo here.

General Le Gendre will be obliged by your sending the courier back immediately.

Yours very truly
(Signed) John Pitman.

Verbal Reply Sent.
That they were having breakfast and the courier was to return quick as they were to leave in half an hour.

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copy

October, 27, Peking

Dear Mr Pitman,

It will be settled the difficulty between China and Japan for the negociations will take place again at Sung le yamen to-morrow as Mr. Wade has been running between Chinese Government and Mr Okubo since you left here so that I shall go back to Japan as a mission by the mail of 31th inst. therefore You will prepare the informa-tions of chinese army for me.

Yours truly

(Signed) W. Fukuwara

Please give this letter to any Japa-nese.

I shall leave here to-morrow afternoon or the day after to-morrow early morning and come down to Tientsin by land.

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136 Copy. October 26th.

My dear Mr Pitman,

Mr Wade has been Mr. Okubo's Hotel yesterday afternoon and has required him to give more time to Chinese Government though Mr Okubo did not answer at once but after he has been thinking he had made up his mind and went to British legation very late last night and gave Chinese Government time until 4 o'clock P.M. D'Christ the Chinese Government will give way everything by this time, but they will not pay three millions.

Please let General LeGendre know all about it

Yours truly

(Signed) K. Fukuwara

I shall come down to Tientsin sometime to-morrow.

No 13. Tientsin, October, 30th, 1874.

Your Excellency,

As stated in my no 12 I left Peking on the 25th instant at 2 P.M. and reached Yung chow at 8 P.M. Yesterday afternoon learned that, during the evening of the same day, conferences were held between Mr Okubo and Mr Wade which led to a reopening of the negociations. Suspecting that this might be the case, I concluded to delay my departure from Yung chow until the next day at 11 o'cl and I requested Mr Pitman, who accompanied me, to write to Mr Fukuwara and ascertain what the state of affair was. My Courier returned with a verbal message that Mr Okubo was just about starting for Yung-chow, and would be there during the afternoon - On hearing this I left Yung chow rather disappointed.

Great was my surprise, as Your Excellency may imagine, when, the day before yesterday, on my arrival here, Mr Pitman communicated to me a note from Mr Fukuwara Copy of which I enclose, and yesterday

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